



RoboHon to go on sale

RoboHon, Sharp's phone to go on sale soon. This robot is definitely cute and adorable. <http://dgit.in/Robohonup>



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Bazaar

Xiaomi Mi 5

Five for Fighting

To be a best, a smartphone must have the best performance possible. If it can do that within a budget, it becomes even better. That's exactly where the Xiaomi Mi 5 excels. The Snapdragon 820 is downclocked to 1.8 Ghz, but it can still go toe to toe against the Exynos 8890 on the Galaxy S7 Edge. Xiaomi made the right choice, going for an FHD display, which reduces the load, compared to a QHD screen, and allows better frame rates.

Further, 3GB of RAM is enough for the most resource intensive games, but 4GB would indeed have been better. The Xiaomi Mi 5 can't keep as many apps running in the background, as a Galaxy S7 Edge can. That said, for most regular users, there's enough and more RAM. The fact that the phone doesn't heat up also makes it feel better. The Xiaomi Mi 5 almost never goes above 40 degrees, and the processor barely throttles.

While the Mi 5's performance is its strength, its camera is its main weakness. The 16MP Sony IMX298 sensor just doesn't make the cut, against flagship cameras. For its price, the Mi 5 still has a respectable camera, but phones like the OnePlus 2 and Honor 7 edge past it. Even Xiaomi's own Mi 4 is a better shooter. The Mi 5's camera is really weak in low light conditions, losing out on most of the details, and doesn't do so well with colours either. While images are satisfactory under well lit conditions, in indoor conditions and lower lights, the phone just isn't the best, especially by Xiaomi standards.

Moving on, the Mi 5 is a very well built smartphone. The curves on the back, and the fact that it weighs only 129 grams, makes it very ergonomic. The only complaint with the build is that the glass on the back is slippery and the phone can slide off flat surfaces often. Overall though, it's a good looking phone that feels very premium.

The 5.5 inch FHD display is has a bluish tinge to it, but you can correct that by turning on Reading Mode and lowering the intensity. Very few would notice the blue bias though. What you will notice, is the buggy UI. Our Xiaomi Mi 5 unit can't open Google Now On Tap, and the company has said that it's working on fixing this bug. There are some other bugs as well, but Xiaomi said that final models will ship with stable MiUI 7 versions.

For all its performance, the Mi 5's battery life also takes a hit. To be clear, it's not bad battery life for a flagship device, but the Snapdragon 820's power



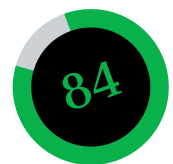
doesn't allow the 3000 mAh battery to last a full day on heavy usage. It's possible on the Redmi Note 3, which is powered by a Snapdragon 650 SoC. The Xiaomi Mi 5 will require charging twice, on heavy usage, and that's where the fast charging tech comes in. The second time, you can just charge till 40-50% to get you through the day.

It's worth noting that while the Mi 5 supports Qualcomm's Quick Charge 3.0 technology, the charger shipping with the phone will be a Quick Charge 2.0 compatible unit. It should be enough for more, but you'll have to buy a Quick Charge 3.0 compatible charger if you want to use that technology.

The difference between Quick Charge 3.0 and 2.0 lies basically in the way electricity is consumed. Smartphone batteries tend to reduce the electricity consumption as they charge, but quick charge 3.0 ensures that the battery draws just enough power needed to charge it fast. This allows less leakage and heat formation.

Overall, the Xiaomi Mi 5 is definitely a flagship class smartphone, but under a mid-ranged pricing. If you want a powerful and good looking smartphone, on a budget, this is the phone to go for. Yes, the OnePlus 2 and Honor 7 have better cameras, but the performance more than makes up for it, and the Mi 5's camera would do for those who aren't camera enthusiasts anyway. At ₹24,999, it's one of the most value for money smartphones in the market.

Prasid Banerjee



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Specifications

Display: 5.15 inch FHD;
Processor: 1.8 Ghz Snapdragon 820 quad-core;
RAM: 3GB; **ROM:** 32GB, not expandable; **Camera:** 16MP, 4MP Ultrapixel; **Battery:** 3000 mAh; **Operating System:** Android 6.0 Marshmallow

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